Screen Stream

User Guide - share a Windows screen to a browser on another computer

What it does

Screen Stream is a single program file, **screen-stream.bat**, plus a settings file it creates by itself. It shows the screen of one Windows computer live in a web browser on another computer on the same network. Nothing needs to be installed on either computer, and administrator rights are not required.

It is built to be light: the screen is captured only while someone is watching, and an image is sent over the network only when the screen has changed.

Requirements

- **Sharing computer:** Windows 10 or Windows 11.
- **Viewing computer:** any device with a modern browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox, Safari), including phones and tablets.
- Both devices must be on the same local network.

Start sharing

1 Double-click **screen-stream.bat** on the computer whose screen you want to share.

2 The first time, Windows Firewall may ask whether to allow **Windows PowerShell** on the network. Choose **Allow access** for private networks.

3 A console window opens and shows the address to use, for example:

```
http://192.168.1.34:8080
```

Watch the screen

1 On the other computer, open a browser.

2 Type the address shown in the console window and press Enter.

3 The shared screen appears and updates automatically. It fits the browser window.

When the browser tab is hidden or minimized, it stops requesting images until you return to it.

Status indicator

An animated arrow next to the address shows the current state:

Arrow	Meaning
--> Orange	Running and waiting. No one is watching.
--> Green	A browser is watching the screen right now.

Stop sharing

Press **Ctrl+C** in the console window. The window closes immediately. The window's close button (X) is disabled on purpose, so the stream is not stopped by accident.

Settings

Settings are stored in **screen-stream.ini**, next to screen-stream.bat. The file is created automatically with the default values the first time Screen Stream runs.

To change a setting, open **screen-stream.ini** in Notepad, change the number after the = sign (for example `Fps=5`), save, and restart Screen Stream. If a value is missing or out of range, the default is used and a message is shown in the console window.

Setting	Default	What it controls
Port	8080	Network port used in the address.
Fps (1-30)	2	Images per second. 1-2 for documents, about 5 for smoother movement. Higher values use more CPU and network.
Width	1280	Width of the image in pixels. Lower values (e.g. 960) reduce network use.
Quality	60	JPEG quality from 1 to 100. Lower values (e.g. 40) give smaller images.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
"Cannot start on port 8080"	Another Screen Stream window is still open, or another program uses the port. Close the other window, or change Port in screen-stream.ini (e.g. to 8090).
The page does not open on the other computer	Check that both devices are on the same network, that the address is typed exactly, and that Windows Firewall allows Windows PowerShell on private networks.
The image freezes	This is normal while the sharing computer shows the lock screen or a Windows permission (UAC) prompt. It resumes automatically.
The stream is slow or jerky	Increase Fps, or lower Width and Quality in screen-stream.ini to reduce the image size.

Good to know

- Only the main monitor is shared.
- The mouse pointer is not shown in the image.
- Viewing only: the viewer cannot control the shared computer.
- There is no password. Anyone on the same network who knows the address can watch. Use it only on networks you trust.